Sketching Graphs of Parametric Equations

Exam code: 9MA0

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Written by: Paul
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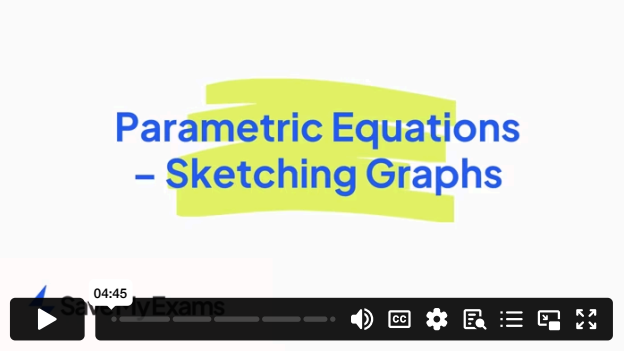

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Help me understand

Sketching graphs of parametric equations

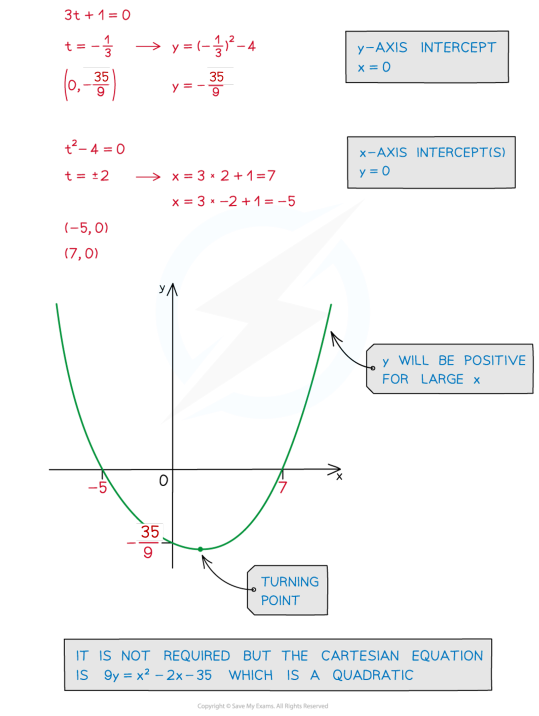
How do I sketch a graph from parametric equations?

- **Plotting** a graph is covered in Parametric Equations - Basics

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it



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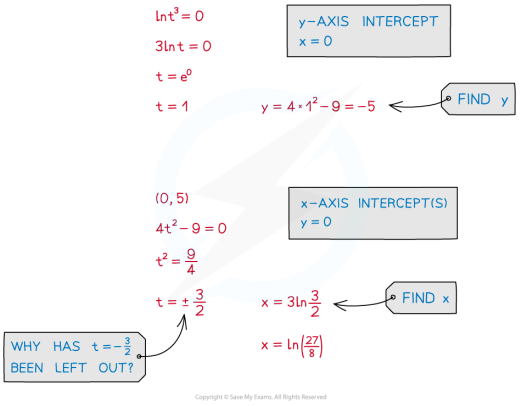
- Still find the key features of a graph …
- … the **y**-axis intercept
  - … the **x**-axis intercept(s)
  - … asymptotes
  - … location of (and if required coordinates of) stationary points (see Parametric Differentiation)
- **Sketch** these points and join up accordingly



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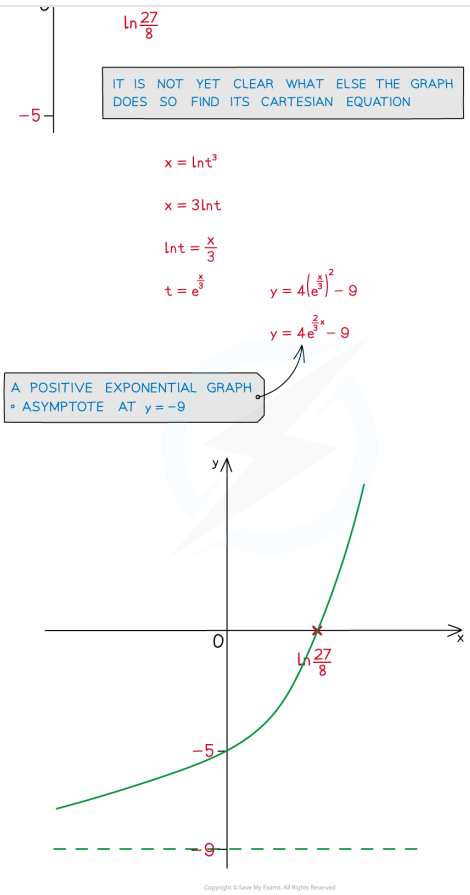

Examiner Tips and Tricks

- Not all curves defined parametrically lead to familiar shaped graphs and it may be worth plotting a few extra points by calculating them.
- Your calculator may be able to produce a table of values quickly, however, remember you are sketching and not plotting.
- It may be easier to find the Cartesian equation first and draw the graph from that – this will depend on the question.
- It is only a **definite** strategy if you cannot make progress otherwise.
- If you are given the sketch of a graph it is usually only for reference and can be used to check answers for axes intercepts, etc.

Worked Example

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